



The author starts his book in the same manner as the Qur`ān, with the basmalah, whilst practising upon the ḥadīth of the Prophet ﷺ which states:

كُلُّ أَمْرٍ ذِي بَالٍ لَا يُبْدَأُ فِيهِ بِبِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ فَهُوَ أَقْطَعُ¹⁴

Every good deed, which is not started with بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ is severed from blessing.¹⁵

TEXT: 1

يَقُولُ رَاجِي رَحْمَةِ الْغَفُورِ * دَوْمًا سُلَيْمَانُ هُوَ الْجَمْزُورِي

VOCABULARY:

يَقُولُ - he says

رَاجِي - a person who hopes

رَحْمَةً - mercy

الْغَفُورُ - the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Forgiving

دَوْمًا - more commonly used as دَائِمًا which means always

سُلَيْمَانُ - the name of the author

هُوَ - a pronoun meaning he, him or it

الْجَمْزُورِي - he comes from the place of Jamzūr. This has been mentioned above in the biography of the author.

¹⁴ What is meant by مَقْطُوعُ الْبَرَكَاتِ is أَقْطَعُ ; cut or severed from blessing.

¹⁵ *Tabaqāt al-Shāfi'iyyah al-Kubrā* , vol.1, pg.12. *Al-Jāmi' li akhlāq al-rāwī wa ādāb al-sāmi'*, vol 2 pg. 87, ḥadīth no: 1231, 1232. *Al-Adhkār al-Nawawī*, pg.198

TRANSLATION:

1. Says he who always hopes for the mercy of the Oft-Forgiving, who is Sulaimān Al-Jamzūrī.

TEXT: 2

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ مُصَلِّياً عَلَى * مُحَمَّدٍ وَآلِهِ وَ مَنْ تَلَا

VOCABULARY:

الْحَمْدُ – All praise

لِلَّهِ – for Allah

مُصَلِّياً – it stems from the word *ṣalāh*, which literally means to pray.

Here, it refers to someone who is praying, or sending salutations.

عَلَى – on, upon

مُحَمَّدٍ – refers to the beloved Prophet ﷺ

وَ – and

آلِهِ – āl means family. With the pronoun attached it means his family.

مَنْ – those

تَلَا – to follow / to recite

TRANSLATION:

2. All praise is due to Allah, whilst sending salutations upon Muḥammad, his family and those who follow (the Prophet and his companions)¹⁶ / and those who recite the Qur`ān (correctly).¹⁷

EXPLANATION:

The author mentions *Al-ḥamd* (praise) at the beginning of his book in accordance with Qur`ān and the ḥadīth of the Prophet ﷺ :

¹⁶ The portion in brackets is as explained by Jamzūrī in *Fath al-Aqfāl*, pg. 12

¹⁷ This explanation is given by Ḥasan al-Dimashqī

كُلُّ أَمْرٍ ذِي بَالٍ لَا يُبْدَأُ فِيهِ بِالْحَمْدِ لِلَّهِ فَهُوَ أَقْطَعُ
 All good actions not started with the praises of Allah
 are severed of blessing.¹⁸

If the meaning of تَلَا is assumed to be “to follow”, then salutations would be incurred upon those who follow the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions رضي الله عنهم in inculcating their ways. This meaning is offered by most scholars. If the meaning “to recite” is assumed, then salutations will be incurred on all those who recite the Qur`ān correctly and practise its injunctions.

TEXT: 3

وَبَعْدُ: هَذَا النَّظْمُ لِلْمُرِيدِ * فِي التُّونِ وَالتَّنْوِينِ وَ الْمُدُودِ

VOCABULARY:

بَعْدُ - thereafter

هَذَا - this

النَّظْمُ – poetry (this book)

لِلْمُرِيدِ – for the student. *Murid* means follower, in this context referring to a follower of ‘ilm (knowledge).

فِي – literally means in.

التُّونِ - particularly referring to the *nūn sākinah*

التَّنْوِينِ – the *tanwīn* or *nunation* symbolised by ً ، ِ ، ٍ .

الْمُدُودِ – the plural of *madd*

¹⁸ *Sunan Abī Dāwūd*, vol. 4, pg. 2065, ḥadīth no. 4840. *Ibn Mājah*, vol.1, pg. 610, ḥadīth no. 1894. *Musnad Alḥmad*, vol.2, pg.359, ḥadīth no. 8712. *Ibn Hibbān* vol.1, pg.175 ḥadīth no. 2. *Al-Baihaqī*, vol.3, pg. 209

TRANSLATION:

3. Thereafter: this versified text (poetry) is for the student regarding the (rules of) *nūn*, the *tanwīn* and the *mudūd*.

EXPLANATION:

The author states “Thereafter”, meaning after the author has started with Allah's name, praised Allah, and sent salutations upon His beloved Prophet ﷺ, whatever follows is what he actually intends to write about.

The author mentions that he will explain rules regarding the *nūn sākinah*, the *tanwīn* and the *mudūd*. However, other rules beside these are also discussed, the *lām al-ta’rīf*, the *mīm sākinah*, the *nūn* and *mīm* when they are *mushaddad* etc. The reason why the author only mentions *nūn*, *tanwīn* and *mudūd* is because the rules in the book are predominantly concerning them.

In some prints instead of المَدُّودُ the word الْمَمْدُودُ appears. The first is more common and is preferred.¹⁹

TEXT: 4

سَمَّيْتُهُ بِـ (تُحْفَةٍ الْأَطْفَالِ) * عَنْ شَيْخِنَا الْمِيهِيِّ ذِي الْكَمَالِ

VOCABULARY:

سَمَّيْتُهُ — It is derived from the word اسْمٌ which means name. When it appears as سَمَّى , it means to give something a name.

تُحْفَةٍ — gift

¹⁹ Check the copy with side notes written by Sheikh Muḥammad ‘Atīq al-Deobandī. He also gives preference to الْمَدُّودُ since he cites it in the core text.

الأَطْفَالُ – children. It is the plural of طِفْلٌ , which means a child who has not yet matured (*bāligh*). Here, it refers to the beginner who intends to learn *tajwīd*.

عَنْ – from

شَيْخِنَا – our sheikh, or teacher

الْمِيهِي – refers to Jamzūrī's teacher, Nūr al-Dīn 'Alī al-Mīhī.

ذِي الْكَمَالِ – a holder or possessor of perfection

TRANSLATION:

4. I have named it (this book) “a gift for children / for the beginner”, transmitting from our Sheikh Al-Mīhī, the possessor of perfection.

EXPLANATION:

Jamzūrī has named this book “A gift for the beginner”, since it contains the basic rules required for the person intending to study the science of *tajwīd*.

Whatever rules he mentions in the book he transmits (he has learnt) from his teacher Al-Mīhī who was an expert in the field of *qirā`āt* and *tajwīd*. His full name is Nūr al-Dīn 'Alī ibn 'Umr ibn Ḥamd ibn 'Umr ibn Nājī ibn Fanīsh al-Mīhī. He was born in 1139 A.H. In spite of being born blind, he studied under renowned scholars at the Azhar University and became famous as an expert in the field of Qur`ānic studies. He travelled to Tanṭā and taught people Qur`ān and *tajwīd*, so much so that all *sanads* of the people of Tanṭā now go through Al-Mīhī. He is called Al-Mīhī because he hails from a place called Mīha. He died in 1204 A.H. His students include his son Mustafā al-Mīhī.

Al-Mīhī is referred to as the possessor of perfection in everything about himself; manners, character, appearance, knowledge etc.²⁰

²⁰ *Fath al-Aqfāl*, pg.13

Some have restricted this quality of perfection to his knowledge concerning the sciences of the Qur`ān.²¹

In many prints المَيَّي is written as المَيَّي , with a *fathah* on the *mīm*.

However, the more correct pronunciation is with a *kasrah* on the *mīm* since he came from the village named Mīha and not Maiha. Allah knows best.²²

TEXT: 5

أَرْجُو بِهِ أَنْ يَنْفَعَ الطُّلَابَ * وَالْأَجْرَ وَالْقَبُولَ وَالثَّوَابَ

VOCABULARY:

أَرْجُو – I hope

بِهِ – with it (book)

يَنْفَعُ – it will benefit

الطُّلَابَ – the students. Plural of الطَّالِبِ , the student.

الْأَجْرَ – recompense

الْقَبُولَ – acceptance

الثَّوَابَ – reward

TRANSLATION:

5. I hope that it (the book) will benefit the students and (I also wish for) recompense, acceptance and reward.

EXPLANATION:

The author hopes that this book will benefit students in understanding the science of *tajwīd*. He also hopes for acceptance from Allah, and that Allah will reward him for it.

²¹ *Mufīd al-Aqwāl*, pg.10

²² *Manthūmah Tuḥfah al-Atfāl* by Dr Ashraf Tal'at pg.7

The word الطَّالِب is the plural of الطَّالِب , which means someone who is engrossed, absorbed or lost in something (الْمُنْهَمَكُ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ). This is also referred to by the author in the third line as *murīd*.

It includes the beginner (الْمُبْتَدِئ), the intermediate (الْمُتَوَسِّط) and the expert (الْمُنْتَهِي). The beginner is he who has initially embarked on the study of the science of *tajwīd* and is incapable of studying texts on his own. The intermediate is the student who has learnt enough to guide himself in further studies. The expert is he who is capable of understanding the text and its meanings.

الْقَبُول , which means acceptance could have various meanings; “accept him” (the author) due to his writing this book, or “accept the book from him” or “accept both him and the book.”²³

Most are of the opinion that the words الثَّوَاب and الْأَجْر are synonymous. A few scholars differentiate between the words saying that *ajr* is reward that is received after doing a particular action (عَمَل) whereas *thawāb* is reward given by Allah through his mercy and grace with no action required.

In الثَّوَاب and الطَّلَاب there is an additional alif at the end of the words. In Arabic, it is called *alif al-ittilāq*; a general *alif*. It has no bearing on the word itself but is merely used to keep the rhyme scheme of the poetry. It is used often in this book.

²³ *Minḥah dhī al-Jalāl*, pg.39